



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*satyam arthaṃ ca sampāśyed ātmānam atha sākṣiṇaḥ | 8.45a 8.45av/: M
deśaṃ rūpaṃ ca kālāṃ ca vyavahāraavidhau sthitaḥ || 45 || 8.45c*

— Manusmṛti, 8.1.3.7. Judicial Conduct and Reasoning-II (Chapter 7), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Within the tapestry of legal proceedings outlined in the Manusmṛti, this verse shines a light on the profound responsibility held by those entrusted with judgment. It urges the judge, or anyone in a position of authority and decision-making, to deeply contemplate several crucial elements: truth (satyam), purpose (arthaṃ), oneself (ātmānam), and the witnesses (sākṣiṇaḥ). The judge must also consider the place (deśaṃ), appearance (rūpaṃ), and time (kālāṃ) relevant to the dispute. This is not merely a checklist, but a call for holistic awareness.

The emphasis on truth highlights the paramount importance of seeking genuine understanding, not simply adhering to superficial facts. The "purpose" speaks to the underlying intentions and motivations driving the actions of those involved, encouraging a discernment that moves beyond the surface. Introspection, considering "oneself," emphasizes the judge's need for self-awareness, acknowledging their own biases and limitations to ensure impartiality. Scrutinizing the witnesses is vital, requiring careful evaluation of their credibility and potential influences.

The consideration of place, appearance, and time underscores the importance of context. Where did the event occur? What were the circumstances? When did it happen? These elements paint a fuller picture, allowing for a more nuanced and accurate judgment.

In modern life, this ancient wisdom extends far beyond the courtroom. Whether you are mediating a conflict between friends, making a business decision, or even navigating your own internal struggles, the principles remain relevant. Consider the truth of the situation, the underlying purpose, your own biases, and the context in which the events unfold. By embracing this holistic approach, you can move toward more just, compassionate, and effective outcomes. This verse reminds us that true judgment arises not only from knowledge of the law, but from deep wisdom and self-awareness.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you apply these principles of truth, purpose, self-awareness, and contextual understanding to your decisions and interactions today, fostering greater justice and compassion in your own sphere of influence?